

Killer Rigs

If you're looking at assembling a PC for you, we have the essentials covered. Take a look at these rigs

Price Watch

This month we give you the prices of laptops, ultrabooks and ultraportables available in the market right now

Home Entertainment Projectors

The best way to take your entertainment quotient to the next level

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In an ideal world, a home entertainment projector is worth investing in if you have a big house with large rooms and a dedicated movie room (if not a mini theatre). Having said that, no one stops you from contemplating a purchase if you need the convenience of a large screen display that your LCD TV just can't provide. I've noticed that the price range of a "basic" 50-inch TV in many cases exceeds the price of a reasonably good home projector. And if you're not particularly a fan of smart, intelligent TVs (that let you surf the Web, play games, support gesture and voice control, and everything that burns a crater-sized hole through your wallet) a projector is something that increasingly starts to make a lot of sense. Like I said, it's great for projecting a large viewable area either on an overhanging screen or directly onto the smooth wall surface – something that TVs can't match – making projectors a worthwhile medium for super-sizing your movies or gaming sessions.

When you go to market to purchase a projector for your home, don't settle for the cheapest one and don't be swayed by the salesman at any electronic store. More likely than not you'll end up buying a simple business projector devoid of any real entertainment fea-

tures that you'd want for your living room. Trust me when I say this that it's one thing reading documents and completely another watching a fast-paced movie off a projector that's not meant for it – it's a painful experience made doubly painful if you paid good money for it. So beware of buying a lemon. Also portable projectors are ok if you travel a lot, but a strict no-no if you're considering them as your primary TV replacement cum entertainment option for home. They simply don't perform as well as I'd want them to.

Now that I've told you what not to do, let's try and focus on what to look for in your quest to buying a good home entertainment projector. If you don't have too much real estate to play with, consider purchasing a ultra short throw projector – they're specifically made to project a 50-inch or greater picture from just a few centimetres away from the screen. Take note, however, that there aren't too many short throw projectors meant for home entertainment use – most are categorized for business use – so if you find one, be prepared to pay a hefty pre-

mium. In my experience, BenQ, Ricoh and Viewsonic's short throw projectors are worth checking out.

As per my observations, 3LCD projectors are slightly better than conventional DLP ones, in terms of overall picture quality. Since 3LCD is patented by Epson, their home entertainment projectors are definitely top notch and worth checking out (but they aren't cheap). At your local Reliance Digital, Croma or Ezone, try playing with Epson's EH-TW series or Viewsonic's Pro series geared for home entertainment. They're pretty good.

3D is slowly coming off age not only in cinema halls and TVs but also in projectors, I've noticed. However, when you purchase a 3D-capable projector, ensure you invest in the requisite 3D glasses. Don't expect a 3D projector to have more than two pairs of glasses. As far as projector screens go, just buy the cheapest one out there – it doesn't really make a huge difference unless you have the eyes of a hawk. I use a basic ₹1,500 white-on-black six feet hanging screen for my movie sessions at home. 

